

UPDATED CORE DIRECTION: Remove the Light/Dark moral-choice system. The game is now a supernatural investigation thriller built around evidence, contradictions, memory reconstruction, escalating twists, and the final reveal that Elias caused the Veyra incident.

Echoes of Sorrow — Game Blueprint (Fill-In)

Oct 4, 2026 · Team Indiesigners · TGC GameJam 2026 (Comic × Twist × Light) · INVESTIGATION THRILLER
REVISION

How to use this doc

Fill every empty **Answer** cell. Once every Answer cell is filled, the coders can build the whole game from this doc without asking anything else. Each question has a **hint** with a suggested default; write "default" to accept it.

Part	Owner	Due
A Core rules	Dev A + whole team	H14
B Story bible, D Investigation deductions	Designer 1	H16
C Characters	Designer 2 (looks), Designer 1 (voice)	H18
H Witness memory pages	Designer 1 (text), Designer 2 (layout)	H20
E-G, I-M, R	Designer 1	H36
N Animation	Dev B + Designer 2	H36
O Audio, J Casebook, U Submission	Dev C	H36
P Art list	Designer 2	H24
Q Pacing, S Settings, T Playtest	Whole team	H36

Rules for filling it in:

- **Never write "TBD"**. Write "cut" if a feature is dropped, so the coders know not to build it.
- **Use the moment IDs exactly** (sis_1, bro_2, mom_3). The code matches on them.
- **Write on-screen text exactly as the player will read it**. No placeholders like "something sad here".
- **A sketch beats a description**. Paste photos of paper sketches straight into the doc next to the question.
- **Disagree in comments, decide in the cell**. The cell holds the final answer only.

The filled doc gets exported into the repo as `design/blueprint.md`. The Sheet-style tables (Parts D, H, M) become `content/*.*.csv`, which the game reads.

Part A — Core rules & systems

These answers become the game's logic, so they come first. Each one changes what the coders build.

#	Question	Hint / suggested default	Answer
A1	How does a ghost leave?	Release after its core contradiction is reconstructed	A ghost is released when the player reconstructs that witness's core contradiction and the witness accepts the recovered memory. There are no Light/Dark exit states.
A2	In what order can the player visit the witnesses?	All 3 open from the start	All three witnesses are available from the start in any order. The order changes which clues are encountered first, but no

#	Question	Hint / suggested default	Answer
			required clue is permanently blocked.
A3	How many fragments are needed before a deduction unlocks?	A small evidence set per deduction	Each core deduction requires 2-3 specific evidence fragments. Optional evidence adds context but never hard-gates completion.
A4	How many hidden evidence fragments per page, and is there a counter?	4-6 per page	Five evidence fragments per witness memory page; counter shows "Evidence 0/5".
A5	Can the player revise a hypothesis?	Allow investigation mistakes without a fail state	Yes. Hypotheses can be revised while investigating. Confirmed deductions are recorded, and the player can always revisit the supporting evidence.
A6	Two clues seem to contradict each other. Which wins?	Contradiction is part of the mystery	Neither wins automatically. Both remain visible; the player investigates their source and context. The casebook marks the relationship as CONTRADICTION until resolved.
A7	How does a clue look after another clue explains it?	Use evidence tags	Cards receive CORROBORATES, CONTRADICTS, or REVEALS tags so the relationship is explicit.
A8	Can the player re-enter a completed memory scene?	Yes, read-only	Yes. Completed memory scenes can be re-opened read-only to inspect evidence and compare it with the casebook.
A9	When can the casebook be opened?	Any time	Any time from the village, conversations, memory scenes, deduction screens, aftermath, hidden archive, and finale setup.
A10	Are witness conversations linear, or can the player pick questions?	Use evidence-gated investigation questions	The conversation is authored, but the player selects from a small set of investigation questions. New questions unlock when relevant evidence is found.
A11	Is there a final Light/Dark moral choice?	Remove it	cut. There is no final moral choice. The climax is a fixed evidence reconstruction that reveals Elias's role.
A12	Does the finale change with what each witness contributes?	Yes, each witness supplies a missing piece	Yes. The finale uses decisive evidence from Mira, Arun, and Leela, then combines it into one reconstructed timeline.
A13	Does an unresolved witness block the finale?	Require the core deductions, not an exit morality state	A witness does not block the game by "staying". The hidden archive opens only after all nine core deductions are confirmed.
A14	Is there any fail state or hard time pressure?	No timer; tension from scripted events	No fail state and no hard timer. Tension comes from disturbances, contradictions, locked locations, the archive collapse, and the personal nature of the clues.
A15	How many endings are there?	Prefer one canonical ending for a short mystery	One main canonical ending. A hidden epilogue appears only if all optional evidence is found.

#	Question	Hint / suggested default	Answer
A16	Save system?	Autosave investigation milestones	One browser autosave after every new clue, confirmed deduction, discovered location, and finale step; title has Continue and New Game.
A17	Platform and input?	Desktop browser, mouse-first	Desktop browser, mouse-first, 16:9 canvas with letterboxing; keyboard shortcuts are optional; no mobile target.
A18	What rewards replaying?	Alternate witness order and optional evidence	Replay value comes from different witness order, optional evidence fragments, early silhouette clues, and the hidden epilogue.
A19	Do evidence discoveries trigger recursive deductions?	Avoid hidden chain reactions	confirmed. Evidence only unlocks the explicitly authored questions/deductions it supports; no recursive automatic story resolution.
A20	When do evidence relationships appear?	Immediately after the second related clue exists	confirmed. A casebook thread appears as soon as both related clues are known and the relationship is authored.

Part B — Story bible

The story bible is the hidden truth that every page must agree with. The player never reads it directly. Write it first, because every later part depends on it.

B1. The truth

Question	Hint	Answer
What really happened in the village, in one paragraph?	Write the truth in chronological order	Ten years before the game, Veyra housed an experimental Echo Lantern that could record, extract and transfer memories. Elias Vane was a young apprentice under Leela, the village archivist and lantern keeper. Desperate to save his seriously ill younger sister Nia, Elias secretly linked the village lantern network to the Echo Lantern and used Nia as the first test case. At 2:17 AM the system overloaded: underground channels opened, the river was diverted, bells and clocks froze, and many villagers were pulled into a repeating memory state. Some disappeared physically; others became memory-bound ghosts. Several days later, after roads reopened and the missing population became undeniable, a search party entered Veyra and found meals, belongings, frozen clocks, black residue and no bodies that explained the disappearance. Elias survived and used the lantern to distort the memories that proved his involvement, including his own. In the present he returns as a ghostbuster believing an anonymous case brought him here, but the investigation reveals that he caused the incident, the cover-up, and the

Question	Hint	Answer
		reason he came back.
What exactly did the ghostbuster do to these people?	Make the culprit's actions concrete	Elias illegally activated the Echo Lantern through the village network, using Nia and the villagers as memory anchors. When the experiment failed he triggered a second pulse to overwrite witness memories, hid the records, and later purged his own memory. His actions caused the disappearances, ghost loops, false timeline and haunting.
Why are the ghosts stuck?	Tie them to unfinished stories	Their consciousness was pulled into the Echo Lantern's shared memory field at 2:17. Each retained a different fragment, and Elias's later edits disconnected those fragments, trapping them inside contradictory memories.
Does the ghostbuster know he is lying, or has he truly forgotten?	Tragic reveal works best if the narrator believes himself	He genuinely forgot the full truth after using the lantern on himself. His investigation notes are sincere but unreliable.
Who is the ghostbuster telling this story to?	Player or an implied listener	The player is the implied investigator/listener. Elias's field notes function as narration, but the player gradually realizes that the narrator is also evidence.
Why did the ghostbuster come back to this village?	Separate stated reason from real reason	Stated: he received an anonymous request to investigate a long-unsolved disappearance. Real: the reactivated Echo Lantern began pulling his erased memories back toward Veyra. The case request is eventually revealed to be written in Elias's own handwriting.
What is the one-sentence theme of the game?	A mystery theme tied to Light	The truth you bury can become the case that hunts you.
What is the tone balance between sad and comic?	Use comedy only as relief	80% mystery/thriller, 15% melancholy, 5% dry comic relief. Never joke about death, disappearance or grief.

B2. Timeline of real events

One row per event, oldest first. Add rows as needed.

When	What happened	Who was there	Who remembers it, and how
10 years before	Elias is a young apprentice under Leela; his sister Nia is seriously ill. Elias secretly studies the Echo Lantern and decides to attempt a memory-preservation experiment.	Elias, Leela, Nia	Leela remembers warning him. Elias later remembers only fragments and believes he was trying to help.
Incident night, 2:17 AM	Elias activates the village lantern network. The Echo Lantern overloads, underground channels open, the river diverts, clocks and bells freeze, and villagers disappear into a shared memory field.	Elias, Nia, Mira, Arun, Leela, villagers	The three main ghosts retain different pieces. Elias later remembers none of his responsibility.
Four days later	Roads reopen. A search party enters Veyra after repeated failed contacts and finds intact homes, unfinished meals,	Search party	The official report records a mass disappearance with no clear cause.

When	What happened	Who was there	Who remembers it, and how
	belongings, frozen clocks and black residue but no bodies explaining the disappearance.		
Following months and years	Authorities fail to solve the case. Elias uses a second pulse to distort witness records, hides the master log, purges his own memory and leaves Veyra.	Elias, officials, surviving witnesses	The public remembers a disappearance; the ghosts remember fragments; Elias remembers himself only as a future ghostbuster.
Present day	An anonymous case request brings Elias to Veyra. He investigates Mira, Arun and Leela, enters the memory echoes, finds the hidden archive and reconstructs the truth.	Elias and the three ghosts	The player gradually gains the full timeline; Elias recognizes himself only near the end.

B3. The ghosts

Question	Sister	Brother	Mother
Name, age, one-line role	Mira, 28 - schoolteacher and sharp visual witness.	Arun, 24 - ferryman and timeline witness.	Leela, 56 - archivist and keeper of the Echo Lantern records.
How and when did they die/disappear?	Pulled into the memory field while trying to reach the clock tower after the first pulse.	Pulled into the memory field after returning from the river and seeing the figure carrying Nia.	Killed in the lantern chamber overload while trying to shut the network; her consciousness remained bound to the archive.
What unfinished mystery keeps them here?	She cannot identify the hand that rang the bell or reconcile the recurring figure.	He cannot reconcile his 2:31 pocket watch with the village clocks frozen at 2:17.	She cannot accept that she trusted Elias with the lantern and failed to stop the experiment.
What do they currently believe?	A stranger or unknown rescuer triggered the bell and caused the panic.	The river disappeared before the figure helped carry someone toward the lantern-house.	The lantern malfunctioned and the frightened apprentice tried to fix it.
What can the investigation prove through them?	The bell was triggered by lantern resonance; the silhouette is the young Elias.	The 2:31 watch proves the night continued after the 2:17 freeze; Nia was the person Elias carried.	The Echo Lantern could bind memories; Elias activated the village network and later purged the evidence.
How do they feel about Elias?	Increasingly suspicious, then angry when his tools appear in her memory.	Frightened by his familiarity and by the fact that the figure matches Elias.	Protective memory turns into guilt and anger when she realizes she enabled his experiment.
How did they know the ghostbuster?	She knew Elias as the village apprentice who repaired school lanterns.	He worked with Elias on river lanterns and trusted him with tools.	She trained Elias and knew exactly what the Echo Lantern could do.
What do they want from the player?	Identify the person who rang the bell and prove what happened at 2:17.	Restore the true timeline and identify the person carrying the lantern.	Find the master record and reveal why Elias activated the machine.

B4. Planting the twist

The twist only feels fair if the clues were there all along. Each page needs at least one clue.

Page	Where the silhouette appears	Narration line that quietly contradicts the panel	Other clue
Intro	Clock-tower reflection in the rain.	"I had never been inside Veyra before."	The silhouette has Elias's exact coat, staff and hand position.
Mira page	Beside the bell rope in P4.	"I remembered the bell, but not the hand that made it ring."	A lantern-resonance mark is visible where a person should be.
Arun page	On the dry river path in P4.	"The road should have taken me away from the tower."	The figure carries the same narrow case as Elias's

Page	Where the silhouette appears	Narration line that quietly contradicts the panel	Other clue
			equipment.
Leela page	Beside the Echo Lantern console in P6.	"Leela warned him once. I did not remember why."	The console layout matches a sketch in Elias's current casebook.
Casebook	THE FIGURE card uses the same outline every time.	"I could not place the figure, but I could place his tools."	The case request, apprentice log and current lantern notes share Elias's handwriting.

Part C — Characters

Each column is one character card, and Designer 2 draws from it. The silhouette row matters most: the ghostbuster must be recognisable from outline alone, or the final reveal won't land.

Question	Ghostbuster	Sister	Brother	Mother
Name, age, one-line role	Elias Vane, 26 - freelance ghostbuster, former Veyra apprentice and unreliable narrator.	Mira, 28 - protective schoolteacher and visual witness.	Arun, 24 - impulsive ferryman and timeline witness.	Leela, 56 - archivist and keeper of the lantern records.
Silhouette: what makes the outline unique?	Short high-collar coat, narrow-brim hat, long lantern staff, leather evidence satchel.	Long braid, shawl, school satchel and ring of small keys.	Messy hair, rolled sleeves, red scarf and short boat hook.	Long shawl, bun, archive key ring and gloves.
3 main colours	Charcoal, warm amber, muted teal.	Dusty blue, cream, muted maroon.	Olive, rust, cream.	Deep brown, faded violet, cream.
Signature prop	Echo Lantern on staff plus evidence satchel.	School register and bell key.	2:31 pocket watch and river ledger.	Brass archive key and lantern schematic.
Alive look vs ghost look	Shown only in hands, back and coat before the final reveal; young Elias appears in recovered memories.	Recovered-memory form is solid; ghost form is pale with translucent edges.	Recovered-memory form is solid; ghost form is pale with translucent edges.	Recovered-memory form is solid; ghost form is pale with translucent edges.
Expressions needed	Hands/back early; later shock, defensive, frightened, recognition, guilt.	Neutral, observant, suspicious, angry, frightened, relieved.	Neutral, restless, alarmed, frightened, angry, relieved.	Gentle, stern, worried, frightened, guilty, resolved.
Poses needed (reused across panels)	Back, holding lantern, examining clue, writing, kneeling, young-Elias profile.	Standing, pointing, ringing bell, examining register, turning back.	Walking, holding watch, running, pointing down river, turning back.	Holding lantern, warning, writing, operating console, reaching.
Speech style in 3 words	warm, certain, defensive.	observant, clipped, protective.	blunt, restless, vulnerable.	gentle, precise, withholding.
One sample line	"I came here to investigate a disappearance."	"The bell rang, but no hand was on the rope."	"My watch says two-thirty-one. The village says two-seventeen."	"The lantern does not lose people. It keeps them."
Bubble style	Narration boxes before the reveal; direct speech only when recovered memories show Elias.	Speech bubbles with pauses and repeated words when memories conflict.	Speech bubbles with abrupt fragments and timestamp references.	Speech bubbles that become increasingly direct as the archive opens.
Idle animation in the village	Never shown in full before the reveal; lantern glow and notebook movement imply presence.	Slow float and subtle flicker.	Slow float and subtle flicker.	Slow float and subtle flicker.
Reaction to evidence	Early: dismisses familiar details. Mid-game: defensive. Finale: recognizes tools,	Points to visual facts and challenges inconsistencies.	Checks his watch and insists on the corrected timeline.	Becomes emotional when the apprentice log and Nia record are found.

Question	Ghostbuster	Sister	Brother	Mother
	handwriting and face.			

Three questions about the ghostbuster:

Question	Hint	Answer
Is the ghostbuster ever shown in full before the final reveal?	Showing him risks giving away the silhouette.	Never in full. Before the finale, show only hands, back, coat edge, staff and partial reflections. Young Elias can appear only as an obscured figure until the reveal.
Are there villagers or memory echoes other than the 3 witnesses?	Atmospheric extras can make the village feel inhabited by the past.	Yes. Add 6–10 silent memory echoes or background apparitions. They never give essential information, but some can reward careful observation with optional evidence.
Who draws the reference sheets, and by when?	All investigation scenes depend on consistent clue props.	Designer 2 creates reference sheets by H18 and locks final character/prop sheets by H20; Designer 1 checks narrative and evidence consistency.

Part D — Investigation deductions & evidence threads

These two tables are the game's investigation engine: nine core deductions, three per witness, plus explicit evidence relationships.

D1. Moments

These are the game's investigation engine: nine core deductions, three per witness. Each deduction is solved by connecting authored evidence rather than choosing Light/Dark.

ID	Panel	Investigation question	Required evidence	Conclusion / truth	After confirmation	Narrator reaction
sis_1	P3	Who activated the village bell at 2:17?	Untouched bell rope; identical 2:17 timestamps; lantern resonance mark.	The Echo Lantern triggered the bell through the underground network. No person rang it.	Unlock clock-tower basement and first corrected timeline note.	"The bell was never the warning. It was the broadcast."
sis_2	P4	Why do witness memories show different times?	Mira's stopped clock; school stopwatch; Arun's later timestamp.	2:17 is the system freeze. Events continued after the clocks stopped.	Unlock corrected timeline overlay.	"If time was edited, someone edited it on purpose."
sis_3	P5	Who is the fourth figure?	Coat silhouette; lantern staff; apprentice sketch.	The recurring figure is Elias Vane, the former Veyra apprentice.	Unlock sealed apprentice file.	"I knew that shape. I just did not know I knew it."
bro_1	P3	Why did the river disappear?	Dry riverbed; emergency sluice; river ledger.	The river was diverted underground during the lantern overload.	Unlock well and tunnel route.	"The river did not vanish. It was sent somewhere."
bro_2	P2	When did Arun actually see the figure?	2:31 pocket watch; 2:17 village clock; figure sighting.	The night continued after 2:17, proving the village timeline is false.	Unlock post-2:17 timeline segment.	"The night kept moving after the clocks stopped."
bro_3	P4	Who was Elias carrying to the lantern chamber?	Silver hairclip; clinic card; figure silhouette.	Nia was the child in Elias's arms. The experiment was meant to preserve her mind.	Unlock Nia's medical record and motive clue.	"I was not rescuing the village. I was taking someone to the machine."

ID	Panel	Investigation question	Required evidence	Conclusion / truth	After confirmation	Narrator reaction
mom_1	P1	What can the Echo Lantern actually do?	Technical schematic; memory spool; anchor notation.	It can extract, store and transfer memories, and bind multiple minds as anchors.	Unlock the complete ritual diagram.	"I knew what it did. I had forgotten what it could cost."
mom_2	P4	Why were the memories altered?	Edited ledger; overwritten notes; Elias annotations.	Elias triggered a second pulse to erase his role and hide the experiment.	Unlock sealed personal record.	"The missing pieces were not missing. I removed them."
mom_3	P5	What caused the mass disappearance?	Master console; Nia monitor; village network map.	Elias activated the network to save Nia, trapping villagers and creating the ghost loops.	Unlock final archive reconstruction.	"The case stopped being about what happened to them. It became about what I did."

D2. Evidence threads

Evidence thread = an explicit relationship between two clues. Corroborates confirms a fact; Contradicts exposes an inconsistency; Reveals unlocks a hidden identity, motive or location. No automatic inversion or chain-reaction choices.

From	Type (corroborates / contradicts / reveals)	To	Why it makes sense in the story
sis_1	Corroborates	mom_1	The bell's resonance matches the Echo Lantern's documented network behavior.
sis_2	Contradicts	bro_2	The fixed 2:17 clocks conflict with Arun's 2:31 watch, exposing the false timeline.
sis_3	Reveals	bro_3	The same figure and tools connect the apprentice to the person carrying Nia.
bro_1	Corroborates	mom_3	The underground sluice ends beneath the lantern chamber, proving the river was displaced by the network event.
bro_3	Reveals	mom_2	Nia's identity explains why Elias later erased the records: he was protecting the secret experiment and his guilt.
mom_2	Corroborates	sis_3	The erased apprentice entry explains why the photograph and witness memories lost Elias's identity.

Hint: 4–6 evidence threads are enough. More threads mean more cases to write and test.

D3. Evidence-thread checks

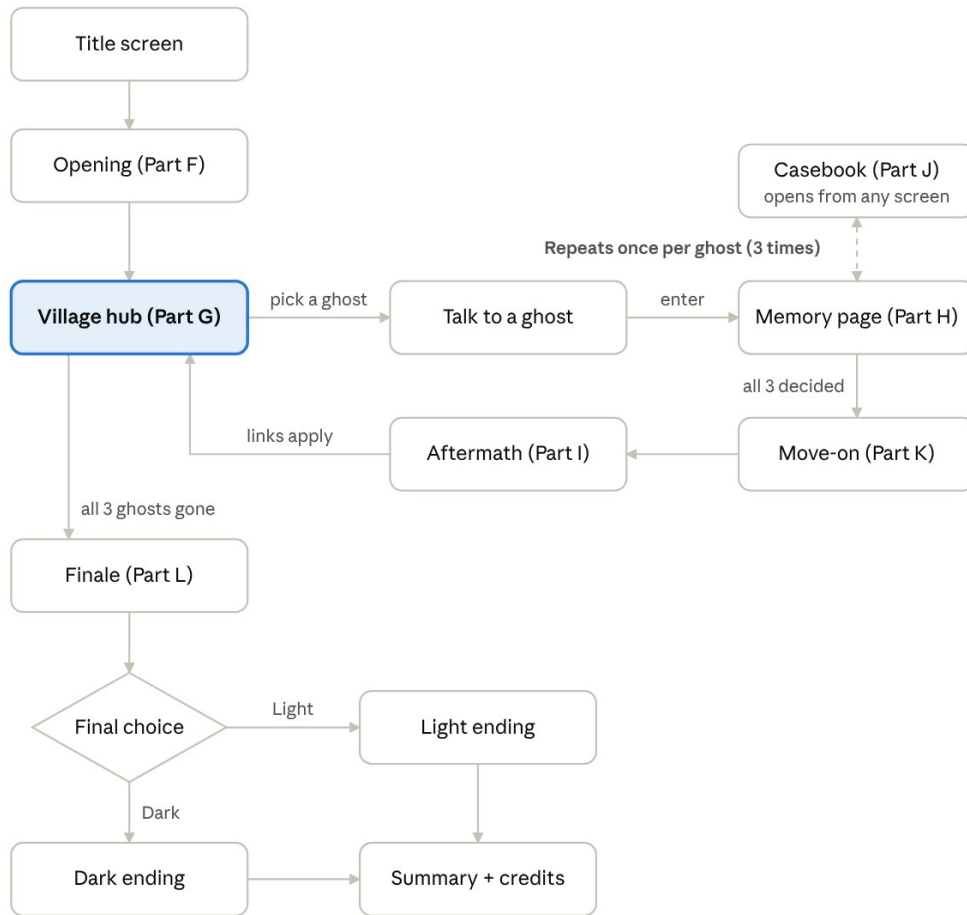
- ☐ No clue is required to have two incompatible meanings without an authored resolution
- ☐ Every witness contributes at least two clues that connect to another witness
- ☐ Every witness has at least one REVEALS relationship
- ☐ At least one contradiction forces the player to revise the initial timeline
- ☐ Every confirmed deduction has at least two supporting pieces of evidence
- ☐ All six witness visit orders have been checked for clue availability and no soft-locks

Visit order	What the player experiences	Anything broken?
Mira → Arun → Leela	Mira supplies the bell clue and time contradiction. Arun turns the contradiction into the river and Nia evidence. Leela then explains the lantern mechanics.	No conflict. The player can still confirm all nine deductions.
Mira → Leela → Arun	Mira exposes the timeline. Leela provides the lantern rules and purge motive early. Arun then confirms the 2:31 event and Nia.	No conflict.
Arun → Mira → Leela	Arun immediately breaks the 2:17 assumption. Mira then identifies the figure. Leela supplies the mechanism and motive.	No conflict.
Arun → Leela → Mira	Arun gives the corrected time first. Leela explains the machine and Nia. Mira later identifies the figure.	No conflict.
Leela → Mira → Arun	Leela reveals the lantern's capabilities. Mira then links the bell to the network. Arun confirms the timeline and Nia.	No conflict.
Leela → Arun → Mira	Leela reveals the machine first. Arun proves the time anomaly and Nia. Mira identifies Elias as the recurring figure.	No conflict.

Part E — Full game flow

The whole game is one investigation arc: village exploration, witness interviews, memory evidence, deductions and newly unlocked locations, followed by the hidden archive and finale.

The game is one loop played once per ghost, then the finale



game flow · investigation loop, nine deductions, hidden archive, one truth ending

Evidence threads update the casebook as soon as related clues are discovered, so later witness conversations can gain new questions without changing earlier evidence.

Screen	What is on screen	What the player can click	What ends it, and where it goes	Change anything?
Title screen	Logo, comic-cover village, "CLICK TO INVESTIGATE", Continue/New Game/Settings/Credits.	Buttons.	Start → Opening; Continue → saved state.	Keep as one scene.
Opening	Six comic frames introducing Veyra, the ten-year disappearance, 2:17 and the first silhouette clue.	Click/Next only.	Frame 6 → Village.	Remove the Light/Dark practice choice.
Village hub	Fixed village at night with three witnesses, investigation hotspots, casebook and menu.	Witnesses, locations, casebook, menu.	Selecting a witness → Conversation; location → Investigation scene; casebook → board.	Village evolves as evidence is uncovered.
Witness conversation	Three to six bubbles plus evidence-gated question	Advance and choose investigation questions.	Key questions answered → Enter Memory.	No moral branching.

Screen	What is on screen	What the player can click	What ends it, and where it goes	Change anything?
	prompts.			
Memory evidence page	Six-panel comic memory, five hidden evidence fragments and spirit-light reveals.	Panels, SFX/object clues, lantern mode, casebook.	Required evidence found → Deduction screen.	Replace Light/Dark buttons with evidence inspection.
Deduction screen	One contradiction/hypothesis card with required clues.	Select clues, confirm deduction, revise hypothesis.	Correct deduction → casebook update; unsupported hypothesis returns to evidence.	No fail state.
Investigation location	New place unlocked by a deduction: clock tower, river tunnel, workshop or archive entrance.	Objects, residue, documents, memory echoes.	Key clue found → Casebook; return → Village.	Use short adventure beats instead of move-on morality scenes.
Witness resolution + aftermath	Witness accepts the reconstructed fact and leaves one final clue.	Read/Continue.	Resolution → Aftermath → Village.	One canonical witness resolution each.
Casebook	Evidence board with clue cards, timeline and relationship threads.	Open cards, pin/unpin hypothesis, inspect thread.	Close → previous scene.	Casebook is the primary deduction interface.
Hidden archive	Secret underground archive beneath Veyra after all nine deductions.	Explore, inspect master console, read logs.	Archive collapse/scripted escape → Finale.	This is the adventure climax before the reveal.
Finale	Fourth mindspace combining all three witness memories, the Figure and Elias's erased records.	Inspect the final reconstruction panels.	All evidence assembled → Truth Reveal → Ending.	No final moral choice.
Truth ending	Canonical 2-4 panel truth reveal and aftermath.	Click to advance.	Ending → Summary + Credits.	One main ending; hidden epilogue only for 100% evidence.
Summary + credits + pause	Investigation summary, nine deductions, optional evidence count, credits, pause/settings.	Back to Title, Play Again, Settings, Resume.	Back to Title.	Keep pause/settings available from all gameplay scenes.

Part F — Title & opening sequence

The opening has about 60 seconds to set the tone, teach the controls and plant the ghostbuster's version of the story.

F1. Title screen

Question	Hint	Answer
What is on the title screen?	Comic-cover image + clear investigation CTA	Logo "ECHOES OF SORROW", comic-cover Veyra image, subtitle "The village remembers you", and "CLICK TO INVESTIGATE". After first click show Continue if a save exists, plus New Game, Settings, Credits.
Which buttons?	Continue/New Game/Settings/Credits	Continue, New Game, Settings, Credits. Continue is hidden when no save exists.
What moves on the screen?	Rain, clock, lantern, silhouette	Rain drifts, the tower clock is frozen at 2:17, the lantern flickers, and a distant silhouette crosses a window once.
What music plays?	Low-volume mystery bed	A restrained mystery piano/drone track at low volume with a quiet clock tick and short paper-page transition cue.

F2. Opening, frame by frame

One row per frame. A frame is one full screen or one panel the player clicks past.

Frame	What we see	Narration box (exact text)	Dialogue (exact text)	SFX	Animation / transition	Player does
1	Rainy Veyra road, case file and lantern held from off-screen.	The file was ten years old. The village was still listed as a disappearance.	-	WIND...	Slow rain; comic panel slides in.	Click
2	Elias sets the lantern down; face never shown.	Three ghosts were said to be trapped here. I thought that was the case.	-	PAPER...	Lantern glow pulses.	Click
3	Clock tower close-up frozen at 2:17.	Every clock in Veyra stopped at the same minute.	-	TICK...TICK...	The hand twitches but never advances.	Click
4	Mira appears by the schoolhouse.	She looked at me as though she had been waiting for ten years.	Mira: "You came back."	KNOCK!	Mira fades in; Elias remains off-frame.	Click
5	Black silhouette appears in a window reflection.	I had never been inside Veyra before. At least, that is what I remembered.	-	GLASS!	Reflection doubles for one beat, then clears.	Click
6	Village hub, three witnesses, clock tower and locked locations.	The case began with a missing village. It would end by asking who had erased it.	-	BELL!	Comic page turns into hub.	Click

F3. Teaching the player

Question	Hint	Answer
How does the player learn to inspect SFX/object clues for evidence?	Pulse the first clue and show one short tip	The first loud clue, "BELL!", pulses with the caption "Inspect the loud comic words and strange objects to uncover evidence." The tip appears once.
Where does the player first use the spirit lantern?	Use it to reveal a hidden investigation clue	At the clock tower. The lantern reveals a residue pattern that matches the Echo Lantern network. This is the first real gameplay use of Light.
What false assumption does the ghostbuster make in the opening?	First twist clue	"I came here to investigate a ten-year-old disappearance." The hidden truth is that the Echo Lantern is pulling him back and the case request is tied to his own past.
How long is the opening?	Under 60 seconds	45–55 seconds for a first-time player; six frames maximum.

Part G — Village hub

The village is one hub the player revisits throughout the investigation, and it should visibly evolve as new evidence and locations are uncovered.

G1. Layout and state

Question	Hint	Answer
What does the village look like?	Fixed hub, no scrolling	One fixed 1920×1080 illustrated Veyra at night: central plaza/well, family houses and school, clock tower, river road, workshop/lantern-house and three witness hotspots. No scrolling.
Where does each witness stand?	Place each near their strongest clue	Mira at the schoolhouse; Arun by the river road; Leela near the lantern-house/workshop. Their positions stay fixed for recognition.
What else can be clicked?	Casebook + evidence locations	Casebook, menu, three witnesses, clock tower, schoolhouse, river path, workshop/well, and new location hotspots unlocked by deductions.
How does the village change as the investigation progresses?	Show knowledge accumulating rather than ghost morality	New evidence marks appear: clock residue, pinned notes, opened routes, lit windows, footprints, archive symbols and the corrected 2:17 timeline.
How does a witness look when new evidence is available?	Small clue indicator	A small evidence shimmer or casebook icon appears near the witness; hover text says "New evidence."
What triggers the final archive?	All core deductions complete	All nine core deductions are confirmed. The well/lantern-house becomes a hotspot labelled "THE RECORD".
What happens on hover over a witness?	Name + investigation status	Hover shows "Unvisited", "Evidence found 2/5", "3/3 deductions", or "Resolved".

G2. Conversations

Write bubbles exactly as shown. Mark redacted words like `[[this]]` and cracked words like `~this~` (see Part R).

Ghost	First conversation (3–6 bubbles)	Line when clicked again before entering	Line after their memory, before the return page
Mira	"You came back." / "The bell rang at 2:17." / "I remember a hand, but not its face." / "Ask what you found." / "ENTER HER MEMORY"	"The rope was untouched. Look at the bell."	"You found the hand I could not remember."
Arun	"The river was moving." / "My watch says 2:31." / "Every clock says 2:17." / "Someone carried a child toward the lantern-house." / "ENTER HIS MEMORY"	"Do not trust the clocks."	"The night kept moving after they stopped it."
Leela	"You have grown." / "I kept records under the floor." / "The lantern was never a toy." / "If you find the master log, read all of it." / "ENTER THE ARCHIVE MEMORY"	"The apprentice knew the rules."	"Some truths were buried because I helped bury them."

Question	Hint	Answer
Does the ghostbuster reply in conversation, or only narrate?	Keep him mysterious before the reveal	Narration boxes only in present-day conversations. Elias does not speak directly until recovered memories reveal his younger self.
How does the player enter a witness	Button after evidence questions	After the last conversation bubble, a large

Question	Hint	Answer
memory?		button appears: "ENTER HER MEMORY", "ENTER HIS MEMORY", or "ENTER THE ARCHIVE MEMORY".

Part H — Mindspace pages

Each witness memory is one comic evidence page of about 6 panels. The pages are investigation scenes rather than moral-choice scenes.

H1. How a page plays

Question	Hint	Answer
Can panels be explored in any order?	Allow clue hunting without losing pacing	Yes. Panels can be explored in any order. Evidence hotspots are available when the player has the correct lantern/equipment state.
How does the player zoom into a panel?	Click panel to enlarge	Click a panel to zoom; other panels dim. Click outside or Close to return.
Where does the investigation deduction appear?	After required evidence is collected	A "RECONSTRUCT" button appears once the required evidence for one core deduction has been found.
Does a deduction change the panel art?	Avoid duplicate art workload	The underlying art stays the same. The evidence overlay and casebook notes update; no Light/Dark recolour branch.
How does the player leave the page?	After required deductions	"LEAVE MEMORY" appears after the page's core deductions are confirmed. Completed pages remain read-only.

H2. Page overview

Question	Sister	Brother	Mother
Page title	The Bell at 2:17	The Dry River	The Lantern Below
Setting: where and when	Schoolhouse and clock tower, incident night	River road and sluice path, incident night	Lantern workshop and underground archive, minutes before and after the overload
Panel layout	2×3 grid; P3/P4 centre emphasis; P6 wide bottom	2×3 grid; P2/P4 wide action panels	2×3 grid; P1/P4 wide setup panels
Which panels hold the 3 core deductions	P3 sis_1; P4 sis_2; P5 sis_3	P3 bro_1; P2 bro_2; P4 bro_3	P1 mom_1; P4 mom_2; P5 mom_3
Where the silhouette hides	P4 beside bell rope	P4 on the dry river path	P6 beside the lantern console
Opening narration box	The bell stopped the same way every clock did.	The river should have carried me away from the tower.	The lantern had rules. I remembered teaching them to him.
Closing narration box	The evidence was clearer than the memory.	The time on my watch was the time they erased.	The machine did not malfunction. Someone told it to do this.

H3. Panel script

One row per panel. Write a key moment's ID in the Moment column. That moment's question and results live in Part D1.

Sister page

Panel	What is drawn (characters + expressions)	Dialogue: speaker, line, bubble type	Narration box	SFX word → fragment text it hides	Moment	Silhouette?
P1	Mira in classroom; register and clock visible.	Mira: "The lesson ended before the bell." (normal)	The village still looked ordinary before the minute that broke it.	BELL! → "The village bell rang at 2:17."	-	No
P2	School clock, stopwatch and register with conflicting marks.	Mira: "They all stopped together." (uneasy)	The clocks agreed too perfectly.	TICK! → "Three clocks stopped at 2:17."	-	No
P3	Clock tower rope untouched; lantern symbol glowing in stone.	Mira: "Who rang it?" (tense)	No hand had pulled the rope. Something else had.	HUM! → "Lantern resonance reached the bell tower."	sis_1	Yes
P4	Mira sees a later timestamp written on a wall ledger.	Mira: "This was written after the bell." (shocked)	The minute was fixed. The night was not.	SCRATCH! → "A later entry reads 2:31."	sis_2	Yes
P5	Black residue and silhouette holding lantern staff.	Mira: "That hand..." (whisper)	I knew the tools before I knew the face.	GLASS! → "The figure carried the apprentice lantern staff."	sis_3	Yes
P6	Register shows erased apprentice entry beside Nia clinic note.	No dialogue.	Someone had tried to remove a name from the story.	PAPER! → "Elias Vane, apprentice - entry removed." / INK! → "Nia Vane - clinic record."	-	No

Brother page

Panel	What is drawn (characters + expressions)	Dialogue: speaker, line, bubble type	Narration box	SFX word → fragment text it hides	Moment	Silhouette?
P1	Arun on riverbank; boat tied at normal water level in first memory layer.	Arun: "The river was moving." (firm)	I remember the water because it was the last ordinary thing.	SPLASH! → "River current recorded before the incident."	-	No
P2	Arun checks pocket watch at 2:31 while village clock shows 2:17.	Arun: "My watch kept going." (frightened)	The watch remembered a different night.	TICK! → "Pocket watch stopped at 2:31."	bro_2	No
P3	Emergency sluice and dry river channel; muddy footprints disappear underground.	Arun: "This was not a drought." (angry)	The river did not vanish. It was diverted.	CLANK! → "Emergency sluice opens beneath the workshop."	bro_1	No
P4	Dry path; silhouette carrying a child toward lantern-house.	Arun: "I saw someone carrying her." (shaken)	The figure moved after 2:17.	FOOTSTEPS! → "Figure crossed the river path." / CLOTH! → "Silver hairclip"	bro_3	Yes

Panel	What is drawn (characters + expressions)	Dialogue: speaker, line, bubble type	Narration box	SFX word → fragment text it hides	Moment	Silhouette?
				caught on the coat."		
P5	Close figure with lantern case marked with partial E.V.	Arun: "I knew the coat." (whisper)	I had seen that case before.	HISS! → "Case initials: E.V."	-	Yes
P6	River floods the underground channel; ghost echoes appear in the water.	No dialogue.	The same water carried the same memory twice.	WHISPER! → "Memory echo repeats the child's route."	-	No

Mother page

Panel	What is drawn (characters + expressions)	Dialogue: speaker, line, bubble type	Narration box	SFX word → fragment text it hides	Moment	Silhouette?
P1	Leela at the Echo Lantern workbench with diagrams.	Leela: "It records. It extracts. It can transfer." (warning)	The lantern was never a simple lamp.	TINK! → "Echo Lantern memory spool."	mom_1	No
P2	Blueprint showing village nodes connected to one chamber.	Leela: "Never connect all nodes at once." (urgent)	The warning was written in her own hand.	HUM! → "32 village anchor points."	-	No
P3	Nia's clinic card beside a child-sized chair and hairclip.	Leela: "She was the test." (hesitant)	Someone had already asked the lantern a question it could not answer.	BEEP! → "Nia Vane - memory preservation notes."	-	No
P4	Young Elias attaching network cables, Leela reaching for him.	Leela: "Elias, stop." Elias: "Just once." (fragmented memory)	I had forgotten the exact shape of the moment.	CLICK! → "Network link opened by Elias."	mom_2	Yes
P5	Console overload; village map lights across every node; black residue spreads.	Leela: "Shut it down!" (shouting)	The lantern did what it had been told to do.	WHOOM! → "All village nodes activated." / CRACK! → "Memory field overload."	mom_3	Yes
P6	Archive collapses; master log, purge note and silhouette at console.	No dialogue.	After the experiment, someone removed his own name from the evidence.	ASH! → "Master log: Elias activated the network." / PAPER! → "Self-purge sequence."	-	Yes

Part I — Return to the village (aftermath page)

The aftermath page is where the player sees what the latest deduction changed in the investigation. It should reveal a new lead without explaining the whole case.

Question	Hint	Answer
What does the aftermath page look like?	"Meanwhile..." comic evidence page	One "Meanwhile..." page with 1-3 newly

Question	Hint	Answer
		discovered panels, documents or locations. Show the latest clue entering the casebook.
Does it name which witness is affected?	Make attribution useful	Yes. Show the affected witness and the exact clue relationship; the casebook becomes easier to follow, not more mysterious.
What if no new thread appeared?	Quiet pacing beat	Show "Nothing new. Recheck the evidence." and return to the village.
Does the witness who just finished appear here?	Use the resolution first	Yes, briefly. Their resolved scene plays first, then the aftermath shows the new investigation lead.
How does the player leave the page?	Return to hub	Click "RETURN TO VILLAGE". The casebook carries a "NEW EVIDENCE" badge when applicable.

One short caption per newly unlocked evidence thread. It explains why the casebook changed.

Evidence thread	Caption shown	Affected witness / reaction line
sis_1 → mom_1	The bell resonance matches the machine's documented network behavior.	Leela: "Then the bell was part of the machine."
sis_2 → bro_2	The 2:17 freeze conflicts with Arun's 2:31 watch.	Arun: "So my watch was right."
sis_3 → bro_3	The same tools identify the fourth figure.	Arun: "That was his case."
bro_1 → mom_3	The hidden sluice ends beneath the lantern chamber.	Leela: "The river was another anchor."
bro_3 → mom_2	Nia's identity explains why the records were erased.	Leela: "He was trying to save her."
mom_2 → sis_3	The deleted apprentice entry explains the missing identity.	Mira: "The name was removed, not forgotten."

Part J — Casebook

The casebook is a corkboard that slowly shows the player how everyone is connected. Threads appear only after a link has fired. It can also build the twist: the ghostbuster's notes about "the figure" get more uneasy each time.

Question	Hint	Answer
How is the board laid out?	Clue cards + timeline + relationship layer	Three witness columns: Mira, Arun, Leela. Above them sits a shared timeline. Bottom-right contains THE FIGURE and NIA cards.
What gets pinned, and when?	Every clue should be traceable	Pin each panel/evidence fragment when first found; pin each confirmed deduction; add a relationship thread when its two endpoint clues are known.
How do evidence relationships look different?	Do not rely on colour alone	CORROBORATES uses a double-line thread; CONTRADICTS uses a broken thread; REVEALS uses an arrowhead and evidence stamp. Labels always name the relationship.
What happens when a card is clicked?	Show evidence in context	Open a large panel overlay with the evidence image, source witness, Elias's handwritten note and linked cards. Close returns to the board.
Can the player rearrange cards?	Fixed layout is faster to build	No. Cards are fixed; the player can select which clues form a working hypothesis, but the board order is stable.
How is a new thread announced?	Small badge + animation	The casebook icon shows "NEW EVIDENCE". Opening the board animates only newly available threads.

Question	Hint	Answer
Does the board change in the finale?	Converge everything on the culprit	Yes. All decisive threads converge on THE FIGURE and NIA, then the Figure card flips to young Elias.

The ghostbuster's notes, one per card. Write them in the narrator's voice (Part R).

Card	Note when first pinned	Note after relationship / deduction	Final note
sis_1	Who rang the bell? The rope was untouched.	Corroborates the lantern network.	The bell was a broadcast, not a warning.
sis_2	Every clock stopped at 2:17.	Contradicts the 2:31 watch.	The timeline was frozen, not the night.
sis_3	A damaged lantern is next to a missing apprentice name.	Reveals the recurring figure as Elias.	The fourth figure was the investigator himself.
bro_1	The river vanished from the surface.	Corroborates the underground network.	The water was diverted into the lantern channels.
bro_2	The watch says 2:31.	Reveals the post-freeze timeline.	The village clock cannot be trusted.
bro_3	A silver hairclip was caught on the figure's coat.	Reveals Nia as the carried child.	Elias was transporting his sister to the machine.
mom_1	The Echo Lantern stores and transfers memory.	Reveals the village-wide anchor mechanism.	The machine could bind many minds at once.
mom_2	The records show deliberate edits.	Corroborates Elias's handwriting and motive.	He erased the evidence after the failure.
mom_3	The master console contains an activation sequence.	Reveals Elias as the operator.	He caused the incident.
THE FIGURE	Same outline appears near every major clue.	Tools match Elias's equipment.	Final reveal: young Elias.
NIA VANE	Clinic card found in Mira and Arun memories.	Matches child carried in the figure scene.	Elias's motive for the forbidden experiment.
THE CASE REQUEST	Anonymous request used as the reason for the investigation.	Handwriting matches Elias's old notes.	He created the investigation that brought him back.

Part K — Witness resolution scenes

Each witness has one canonical resolution scene. Keep each to one short comic beat and reuse poses from Part C.

Ghost	Unresolved loop	Resolution scene	Last line
Mira	Cannot identify who rang the bell or why the figure knew the tower.	Elias places the bell clue beside the lantern residue. Mira recognizes the machine's signature and releases her memory loop.	"Now I remember the hand."
Arun	Cannot reconcile the 2:31 watch with the 2:17 clocks or identify the child.	The corrected timeline and Nia evidence are shown together. Arun accepts that the figure carried Nia after the freeze began.	"The night did not end at two-seventeen."
Leela	Cannot accept that she trusted Elias with the lantern and failed to stop him.	The master log is read aloud. Leela faces the exact record of Elias's activation and her own warning.	"I should have stopped him."

Question	Hint	Answer
What does each witness resolution look like as an animation?	Short, reusable animation	Witness becomes visually stable, their repeated memory frame completes, then

Question	Hint	Answer
		they dissolve into a clean memory-page texture or fade into the background. No separate morality states.
How does each resolution change the village?	Show information, not morality	Their associated location becomes clearer and gains a permanent evidence mark: bell tower, river path, or lantern-house.
Can the player still talk to a resolved witness?	Keep evidence review available	Yes. They have a short fixed line and can be re-opened for read-only testimony, but the core deduction cannot be changed.

Part L — Finale & endings

The finale is the investigation's payoff: the evidence board and memory scenes converge on the recurring silhouette. The player sees that the "mystery" and the investigator are the same case.

L1. Setup

Question	Hint	Answer
Where does the finale take place?	Fourth mindscape + original incident memory	Inside the Echo Lantern's deepest memory layer, represented as a fourth comic page surrounded by a dark archive frame.
What does the player do in it?	Reconstruct, do not choose morality	Inspect eight final evidence panels, compare the timeline, and reveal the silhouette, Nia record, master console and self-purge note.
How does the reveal happen step by step?	Escalate each clue	1) Show the three witnesses' decisive evidence. 2) Show the 2:17/2:31 contradiction. 3) Reveal Nia's record. 4) Reveal the master console. 5) Connect the recurring silhouette. 6) Reveal the case request handwriting. 7) Dissolve the silhouette to young Elias. 8) Show Elias purging his own memory.
How are the witnesses reflected?	One decisive clue per witness	Mira contributes the bell/time clue; Arun contributes the corrected timeline/Nia clue; Leela contributes the machine/master-log clue. All three converge on Elias.

L2. Finale, frame by frame

Frame	What we see	Narration box (what the ghostbuster says)	What the panel actually shows	SFX	Animation	Player does
1	Three witness panels and their resolved evidence cards.	I thought I was solving three separate stories.	Mira, Arun and Leela each hold one part of the same event.	LOW HEARTBEAT...	Panels slide into one investigation board.	Click
2	2:17 clocks overlaid with Arun's 2:31 watch.	The clocks stopped. The night did not.	The fixed time is shown as a false anchor.	TICK...	The 2:31 hand keeps moving.	Click
3	Nia's clinic record beside the child from the memory echo.	I remembered a disappearance. I did not remember her name.	The child is Nia Vane, the person Elias was carrying.	PAPER!	The redacted name resolves.	Click
4	Master console and village	Someone gave the lantern all of	The activation record shows	WHOOM!	Lines spread across the village	Click

Frame	What we see	Narration box (what the ghostbuster says)	What the panel actually shows	SFX	Animation	Player does
	network lit simultaneously.	Veyra.	Elias opening every node.		map.	
5	Casebook threads converge on THE FIGURE.	The stories were never separate.	Every decisive clue points to the same silhouette and tools.	THUMP!	Threads snap into one point.	Click
6	Anonymous case request beside old Elias handwriting.	I did not remember writing the case that brought me here.	The handwriting and paper match Elias's own archived notes.	SCRATCH!	Ink duplicates and aligns.	Click
7	Close black silhouette holding the lantern staff.	I knew the shape because I had been carrying it for years.	The outline becomes the younger Elias.	WHOOM!	Black mask dissolves from the edges inward.	Click
8	Young Elias activates the machine, then reaches for the self-purge control.	I caused the incident. Then I erased the person who caused it.	The original experiment, Nia, the village network and the self-memory purge are shown in one unedited record.	SILENCE... CHIME.	The past overlays the present.	Click Continue

L3. The truth ending and optional full-evidence epilogue

Question	Complete truth ending	Optional full-evidence epilogue
What is the final outcome?	Elias remembers the entire Veyra incident and the player sees the canonical reconstructed truth.	After 100% evidence, the final page briefly shows the master log being archived under Elias's real name.
Final narration	"I came here looking for the person who erased the village. It was me."	"The truth was never missing. I was."
Ending panels	2-4 comic panels: Nia, the overloaded lantern, the vanished village and Elias facing the archive.	One additional panel: the village clock advances from 2:17 to 2:18.
Final visual state	The silhouette is gone; Elias is fully visible; Veyra remains quiet but no longer loops.	The casebook closes on a complete timeline with every required clue connected.
What remains unresolved?	Nothing essential. The main mystery is solved; some emotional details remain intentionally quiet.	Optional side identities and background apparitions can remain unexplained.
Music	Penumbra - Scott Buckley (CC BY 4.0), then a quiet closing piano.	Same, with a single clock tick after the final optional panel.

Question	Hint	Answer
What shows after the ending?	Summary: deductions, evidence and credits	Show Summary: the nine confirmed deductions, witness resolutions, optional evidence count, discovered locations, then Credits. Buttons: "BACK TO TITLE" and "PLAY AGAIN".
Does the player get a hint that other discoveries exist?	Use a replay hook without fake branches	Yes. Show "Some evidence was easier to miss." and a compact evidence completion count without revealing optional epilogue content.

Part M — Popups, prompts & UI text

Every word the interface shows is listed here. Write the exact text; the coders will copy it as written. Add rows for anything missing.

Popup / message	When it appears	Exact text (your answer)	Buttons (exact text)
Audio unlock	First screen, before title	Audio is off. Enable audio for the full investigation?	ENABLE AUDIO
Evidence tip	First time an investigation page opens	Tip: Inspect loud words and strange objects to uncover evidence.	GOT IT
Evidence found	An evidence fragment is revealed	Evidence found: {evidence}	CONTINUE
Investigation ready	A core deduction has enough evidence	Enough evidence collected. Reconstruct the event.	RECONSTRUCT / LATER
Hypothesis prompt	Player opens a deduction	Evidence to compare: {clue_a} {clue_b} Conclusion: {hypothesis}	CONFIRM / BACK
Unsupported hypothesis	Selected clues do not support the current conclusion	The evidence does not support this conclusion yet. Check the timeline.	BACK TO EVIDENCE
Contradiction found	Two clues conflict	CONTRADICTION: {clue_a} does not match {clue_b}.	INSPECT
Deduction confirmed	A core deduction is solved	Deduction confirmed: {deduction}	CONTINUE
New evidence badge	A new relationship or clue appears	NEW EVIDENCE	OPEN CASEBOOK / LATER
Casebook first open	First time casebook opens	Casebook - first clue pinned. Follow the contradictions.	CLOSE
Witness status	Hovering a witness in the village	{ghost} - {status}	No button; hover only
Witness resolved	Core witness deduction complete	{ghost} testimony reconstructed.	RETURN
Archive unlocked	All nine core deductions complete	The hidden archive is open.	ENTER ARCHIVE
Final reconstruction	Entering the last memory layer	The evidence fits. Reconstruct the night.	CONTINUE
Truth revealed	Silhouette and master record are revealed	The investigator was part of the case.	CONTINUE
Ending summary	After the truth ending	Investigation complete.	BACK TO TITLE / PLAY AGAIN

Question	Hint	Answer
What is always on screen?	Casebook icon, menu icon and evidence counter inside investigation pages	Casebook, Menu, and "Evidence 0/5" on memory pages. A small lantern indicator shows when spirit-light inspection is available.
Where do those icons sit?	Top-right, away from the comic art	Top-right with a 16 px safe margin from the canvas edge.
How do popups look?	Comic caption boxes	Caption boxes with comic borders and small fade/scale animation; they do not block the full scene unless needed for confirmation.

Part N — Animation & transitions

Every moving thing in the game is listed here. The coders build all of these in code from still art, so artists draw no frame-by-frame animation. Fill in the look and the duration; the suggested default is in the hint.

Animation	Trigger	Hint / suggested default	How it should look	Duration (s)
Page turn	Entering/leaving a memory	Paper page flip	Paper sheet folds/slides over; masked page curl if available, otherwise 2D wipe.	0.6
Panel zoom	Clicking a panel	Selected panel enlarges	Selected panel scales to 1.06× and recentres; others dim.	0.3
SFX pop	Clicking an evidence word	Word scales and bursts	Evidence word scales 1.0→1.15→1.0 with tiny rotation, then fades.	0.4
Evidence reveal	After clue is inspected	Hidden text/image fades in	Evidence appears under the SFX or object with a small upward motion.	0.5
Spirit-light reveal	Using the lantern	Slow radial glow	A soft light mask expands from the cursor and reveals hidden residue.	0.8
Contradiction mark	Two clues conflict	Broken-line stamp	A "CONTRADICTION" stamp and broken thread appear; no flash.	0.5
Evidence pin	New clue added	Paper card pin	Card slides onto the board and a pin clicks into place.	0.4
Hypothesis confirm	Valid deduction	Stamp + quiet chime	The deduction card gets a stamp and becomes part of the timeline.	0.5
Unsupported hypothesis	Wrong clue set	Small shake	Selected cards nudge apart; no harsh error screen.	0.3
Bubble appear	New witness line	Small bounce	Bubble rises 6 px with ease-out.	0.2
Text reveal	Narration/evidence	Instant by default	Instant text; optional typewriter at 40 cps.	0.5
Ghost idle	In village	Slow float	Vertical float ±4 px and subtle edge flicker.	3 (loop)
Witness resolution	Core deduction complete	Memory frame settles	Ghost's repeated pose stabilizes and dissolves into the casebook texture.	2
Thread draw	Evidence relationship appears	Line draws	Thread grows from source to target card.	0.8
Silhouette reveal	Finale	Black mask dissolves	Black silhouette fades from edges inward; face becomes visible last.	3
Narration collapse	Finale reveal	One controlled glitch	Narration jitters once and is replaced by the true record.	1
Clock anomaly	2:17 investigation clue	Hand twitch	Clock hand moves a few pixels toward 2:18, then snaps back.	0.9
Title idle	Title screen	Rain/lantern/silhouette	Subtle rain, lantern flicker and one silhouette pass.	loop

Question	Hint	Answer
Does anything flash quickly?	Use Reduce Flashing	No strobing. Evidence reveals use slow fades. Reduce Flashing removes the strongest glow pulse and screen shake.
Does the screen shake on big SFX?	Small shake only on investigation impacts	Yes, but only ±3 px for 0.12 s on major

Question	Hint	Answer
		sounds such as WHOOM/CRASH; disabled by Reduce Motion.

Part O — Audio cue sheet

The cue sheet lists every sound in the game: what plays, where, and from which source. There's no voice acting (out of scope). Every pick must be CC0 or CC BY and logged in `CREDITS.md`. The suggested tracks below were checked on their source pages on 3 Oct 2026.

O1. Music

Where	Mood	Suggested track	Your pick	Loops?
Title	Mysterious, inviting	Gymnopedie No. 1, Kevin MacLeod (CC BY 4.0)	Vampire's Piano - TAD, CC0. Use 0.30 volume.	Yes
Opening	Mysterious	Comfortable Mystery, Kevin MacLeod (CC BY 4.0)	Comfortable Mystery - Kevin MacLeod, CC BY 4.0. Use 0.30 volume.	Yes
Village	Quiet investigation	Vampire's Piano, TAD (CC0)	Vampire's Piano - TAD, CC0. Use 0.35 volume.	Yes
Village, late game	Uneasy, investigative	Echoes Of Home, Scott Buckley (CC BY 4.0)	Echoes Of Home - Scott Buckley, CC BY 4.0. Start after the first major deduction.	Yes
Inside a memory	Ghostly and intimate	Ghost Story, Kevin MacLeod (CC BY 4.0)	Ghost Story - Kevin MacLeod, CC BY 4.0. Use 0.28 volume.	Yes
Deduction confirmed	Satisfying, restrained	Heartbreaking, Kevin MacLeod (CC BY 4.0)	Use a 2-second adapted sting from the memory bed or a CC0 chime.	No
Casebook	Thinking, quiet	Calm Piano 1, cynicismusic (CC0)	Calm Piano 1 - cynicismusic, CC0. Use 0.22 volume.	Yes
Archive	Claustrophobic	Lightless Dawn, Kevin MacLeod (CC BY 4.0)	Lightless Dawn - Kevin MacLeod, CC BY 4.0. Use 0.32 volume.	Yes
Finale build-up	Tense	Lightless Dawn, Kevin MacLeod (CC BY 4.0)	Lightless Dawn - Kevin MacLeod, CC BY 4.0. Increase to 0.38 volume.	Yes
Truth reveal	Emotional peak	Penumbra, Scott Buckley (CC BY 4.0)	Penumbra - Scott Buckley, CC BY 4.0. Use 0.45 volume.	No
Truth ending	Somber resolution	Echoes Of Home, Scott Buckley (CC BY 4.0)	Echoes Of Home - Scott Buckley, CC BY 4.0. Use 0.42 volume.	No
Credits	Quiet	Vampire's Piano - TAD (CC0)	Vampire's Piano - TAD, CC0, low volume.	Yes

O2. Sound effects

Event	Suggested sound	Your pick
UI click and hover	Kenney Interface Sounds (CC0)	Create a simple paper/UI tick with ChipTone (CC0).
Page turn	Comic Book Page Turn, CC0 source	Create or use a verified CC0 paper flip.
BELL!	Bell impact	Create a dry distant bell in ChipTone or use a verified CC0 bell.
TICK!	Clock tick	Create a crisp clock tick in ChipTone.
Other evidence words	RING!, HUM!, KNOCK!, FOOTSTEPS!,	Create a small consistent CC0 set in

Event	Suggested sound	Your pick
	SPLASH!, CLANK!, PAPER!, GLASS!, SCRATCH!, BEEP!, WHOOM!, CRACK!, WHISPER!, ASH!, THUMP!	ChipTone; keep the same comic punctuation style.
Evidence found	Small chime	Three-note CC0 chime made in ChipTone.
Spirit-light reveal	Soft magical pulse	Low CC0 glow/pulse made in ChipTone.
Contradiction found	Low click + paper rip	Two-layer CC0 paper/rip cue.
Deduction confirmed	Short stamp + chime	Create a 0.5 s CC0 evidence-stamp sound.
Pin and thread	Paper pin + string pull	Use two short CC0 paper/UI clicks.
Witness near	Ghostly whisper	Use a subtle CC0 whisper; verify the individual license.
Silhouette reveal	Low drone	Create a quiet CC0 drone or use a verified CC0 ambience.

O3. Ambience

Location	Suggested sound	Your pick
Village at night	Crickets, distant water	Use a verified CC0 Freesound night ambience and record creator/URL in CREDITS.md.
Wind / rain	Low storm ambience	Use a verified CC0 wind/rain bed.
Underground archive	Drips, metal resonance	Layer a dry CC0 room tone with sparse metal creaks.

Avoid: Mixkit music (banned in games by its own license), Tallbeard's "Music For Game Jams" (non-commercial only), and free-tier Suno or Udio output (non-commercial, and the company keeps ownership).

Part P — Art spec & asset list

Artists draw every image **once, in full colour**; the code makes the grey, colour and ink versions. All the UI (bubbles, SFX lettering, frames, threads, halftone) is built in code, so the list below is only the drawn art.

P1. Spec

Question	Hint / suggested default	Answer
Canvas size	1920×1080 per full page	1920×1080 master canvas for every full-screen page; panels stay inside a 10% safe margin.
File format	WebP; keep Krita sources	WebP for final static art; keep Krita .kra sources in art-src/. PNG only when alpha compatibility needs it.
File names	Lowercase, no spaces	Lowercase snake_case: mira_p3.webp, arun_p2.webp, leela_p5.webp, figure_silhouette.webp, nia_memory.webp, archive_console.webp.
Layers	Separate reusable art	Background, characters, props, evidence overlays and silhouette separated; export flattened previews plus transparent layers.
Line weight	Consistent comic outlines	6 px character outline and 3–4 px background outline at 1920×1080.
Palette	6–8 colours	Charcoal, paper cream, muted amber, dusty blue, olive, faded violet, near-black, pale spirit teal.
Silhouette	Use final Elias art, masked in code	Use the actual Elias silhouette source; code hides facial details and uses the same shape throughout.
Who checks consistency?	One narrative + one art check	Designer 2 owns visual consistency; Designer 1 signs off evidence, pose and

Question	Hint / suggested default	Answer
		story accuracy.

P2. Asset list

Asset	Count	Owner	Status
Character sheets (5 core characters + Nia)	6	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Expression heads	~30	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Reusable poses	~20	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Title screen	1	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Opening frames	≤6	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Village hub + evidence overlays	1 + overlays	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Mira memory page	6 panels	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Arun memory page	6 panels	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Leela memory page	6 panels	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Investigation locations	4	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Hidden archive scene	1	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Finale panels	8	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Truth ending panels	4–6	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Casebook UI	1	Dev C + Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24
Comic cover / poster	1	Designer 2	Planned - lock by H24

P3. Free assets to save drawing time

All CC0 or public domain, checked on their source pages on 3 Oct 2026.

Need	Source
Spirit-light glow	Original CSS/2D shader or verified CC0 effect
Contradiction marks	Original vector/UI art
Paper texture	ambientCG CC0 or original Krita texture
Casebook board	Original team UI using paper/cork texture
Evidence stamps	Original team UI
Cursors / pointer	Kenney CC0 or original
Background village	Prefer original team art; optional The Outlander CC0 with disclosure if used
Weather particles	Original 2D particles or CC0 pack

Avoid: Unsplash, Pixabay, Freepik and Vecteezy (custom licenses, not CC); any itch.io pack with no license stated; "name your own price" packs without a CC0 or CC BY label.

Part Q — 15-minute pacing budget

The suggested split below targets 15 minutes for a first playthrough. The investigation loop should feel dense, not rushed.

Segment	Suggested (min)	Your target (min)	Word budget (on-screen words)
Title + opening	1.0	1.0	80
Initial village exploration	1.0	1.0	90
Witness 1 investigation	2.5	2.5	220
Investigation location 1	1.0	1.0	110
Witness 2 investigation	2.5	2.5	220
Investigation location 2	1.0	1.0	110
Witness 3 investigation	2.5	2.5	220
Casebook synthesis	0.8	0.8	90
Hidden archive adventure	1.0	1.0	130
Finale + truth reveal	1.2	1.2	150
Ending + credits	0.7	0.7	80

The word budget assumes players read about 200 words a minute and spend substantial time inspecting evidence. Keep any single evidence page below about 220 words so the player has time to look.

Part R — Writing style guide

The style guide keeps investigation text written by different people sounding like one game and keeps the unreliable narrator consistent.

R1. Voice

Question	Hint	Answer
Narration tense and person	Past tense, first person	Past tense, first person. Elias speaks as if he is confidently recounting an investigation, even when his memory is wrong.
How does the narrator's voice change by the finale?	Confident → defensive → fragmented	Opening: warm and professional. Mid-game: increasingly defensive around familiar clues. Finale: short, fragmented and finally direct.
How do ghosts talk?	Distinct witness rhythms	Mira is precise and visual; Arun is blunt and timestamp-driven; Leela is careful and technical. Memory fractures create pauses and repeated phrases.
Any humour, and where?	Keep thriller dominant	Only dry ghostbuster bravado, occasional visual gags, and comic SFX. Never joke about death or the missing villagers.
Content warnings for the itch page	Death, grief, memory manipulation	Content warning: death, disappearance, grief, family illness, guilt, memory manipulation and supernatural horror. No graphic gore.

R2. Length limits

Text	Suggested limit	Your limit
Speech bubble	15 words	15
Narration box	25 words	25
Evidence fragment	20 words	20
Investigation question	12 words	12
Casebook note	20 words	20

R3. Markup the code understands

Use these in any text cell. Don't invent new ones without telling Dev B.

Write	Shows as	Example
[[word]]	Redacted: black bar over the word	The archive entry named [[Elias]].
~word~	Cracked/shaky letters for damaged memory	I remember ~two-seventeen~.
word	Bold emphasis	I wrote it down.
\n	New line in the same bubble	BELL! /n/ TICK! /n/ WHOOM!

The investigation SFX words used in the game (fill in the full list):

Part S — Controls, settings & save

The investigation controls listed here also go into the README

Question	Hint / suggested default	Answer
Mouse controls	Left click everything; hover tooltips	Left click: advance/select/interact. Hover: witness status and tooltips. Mouse wheel: casebook scroll only.
Keyboard shortcuts	Space/Enter, Esc, C	Space/Enter: advance; Esc: pause/menu; C:

Question	Hint / suggested default	Answer
		casebook; L: spirit-light mode; M: mute/unmute. Shortcuts never skip deductions.
Settings in the menu	Audio, text, motion, flashing	Music volume, SFX volume, text size (100/125/150%), text speed (instant/40 cps), Reduce Motion, Reduce Flashing, fullscreen.
Can evidence relationships be understood without colour?	Use labels and patterns	Yes. CORROBORATES, CONTRADICTS and REVEALS are always written and also use distinct line patterns/icons.
What is saved?	All investigation progress	Evidence found, deductions confirmed, locations unlocked, witnesses resolved, casebook notes/threads, finale progress and settings.
Save slots	One auto-save	One auto-save slot using browser localStorage.
Fullscreen	Provide a toggle	Fullscreen toggle plus browser/itch fullscreen support.
Browsers to test	Chrome, Firefox, Edge	Chrome, Firefox and Edge on desktop; test latest stable versions available during submission.
Minimum screen size	1280×720	1280×720 minimum; 1920×1080 target.
Language	English only	English only for jam build.

Part T — Playtest & definition of done

The game works if playtesters notice contradictions, use the casebook to resolve them, understand the final reveal, and want to replay to find optional evidence.

T1. Playtest log

One row per tester. Watch silently and write down where they get stuck.

Tester	Build (hour)	Time taken (min)	Noticed a contradiction?	Used casebook to resolve it?	Wants to replay?	Where they got confused
Tester 1 - fill after external playtest	H30/H55	-	-	-	-	Record exact clue or deduction confusion
Tester 2 - fill after external playtest	H30/H55	-	-	-	-	Record exact clue or deduction confusion
Tester 3 - fill after external playtest	H30/H55	-	-	-	-	Record exact clue or deduction confusion
Tester 4 - fill after external playtest	H30/H55	-	-	-	-	Record exact clue or deduction confusion

T2. Definition of done

- ☐ All 9 deductions can be confirmed from their authored evidence requirements
- ☐ All 6 visit orders reach the finale with no errors
- ☐ Both endings are reachable

- ☐ Average first playthrough is 10–15 minutes
- ☐ No console errors in Chrome, Firefox and Edge
- ☐ Save and Continue work after closing the browser tab
- ☐ The itch.io build loads and plays from a fresh browser
- ☐ Every on-screen text matches this doc (no placeholders left)
- ☐ Every asset in the game is listed in [CREDITS.md](#)

Part U — Submission checklist

These come straight from the event rules. Missing any of the first group means disqualification from the prize pool.

Disqualification risks

- ☐ Public GitHub repo with a LICENSE file
- ☐ Public, browser-playable build on itch.io, uploaded before Hour 100
- ☐ No paid assets anywhere
- ☐ No game code written before Hour 0; every member commits from their own account
- ☐ Nothing backdated on GitHub or itch.io; code freeze at Hour 100

Hour 12

- ☐ Final scope, public repo link and final idea submitted through the official form
- ☐ GitHub link and proposal posted in the team's Discord thread

Repo files

- ☐ README.md shows the itch.io link, setup and run instructions, controls (Part S) and team details
- ☐ CREDITS.md lists every third-party asset with source link and license
- ☐ AI disclosure: every AI tool used (Claude Code for code; any image or sound generators) and what it was used for
- ☐ Krita source files and the story bible committed, as proof of authorship

itch.io page

- ☐ Same credits list as CREDITS.md
- ☐ Cover image, 3–5 screenshots, short description, controls
- ☐ Content warnings (Part R1)
- ☐ Tested in a fresh browser after the final upload

Question	Hint	Answer
Who owns the itch.io page?	One member owns and adds the others	One designated team member creates/owns the itch.io page and adds all team members as collaborators/admins. Confirm the owner in team chat before publishing.
Who uploads the final build, and when?	Final upload by H96 with buffer	Dev C uploads the final build by H96, retests the fresh itch.io page and leaves H97–H100 as fix/rollback buffer.
Which track are we in?	Follow the event roster rule	Check the team roster against the event rule: use UG1 only if every member meets

Question	Hint	Answer
		the specified 2026-batch eligibility; otherwise use General.

Research, Similarity & Implementation Appendix

This appendix was added after reviewing the proposal and fill-in blueprint against comparable games and current free/open resources. It turns the design into an implementation plan without expanding the 10–15 minute scope.

1. What the proposal already establishes

- The player is a young ghostbuster whose narration frames the investigation; the recurring figure is eventually revealed as his younger self.
- The game is a narrative mystery / interactive comic. Memories are six-panel evidence pages, fragments are found through comic SFX and objects, and deductions update the casebook.
- There are three witness arcs with three core deductions each. Evidence threads are explicit corroborates/contradicts/reveals relationships. There are no moral-choice choice states and no recursive chain reactions.
- Witness order is free. Earlier discoveries unlock stronger questions in later conversations, but no required clue is permanently blocked.
- Jam scope is one small village hub, three witness memory pages, four investigation locations, one hidden archive, one finale, roughly 10–15 minutes, no combat, no open world, no voice acting and no full cutscenes.

2. Comparable games — what is similar and what is not

Game	Relevant similarity	What to borrow	Important difference
Papers, Please	Incomplete information with meaningful uncertainty	Make evidence incomplete enough that the player must hesitate.	Echoes is a supernatural investigation, not a document simulation.
Return of the Obra Dinn	Evidence and logical reconstruction	Let the player reconstruct events from partial visual evidence.	Echoes has a small authored evidence set rather than a huge deduction space.
Her Story	Fragmented, contradictory archive storytelling	Contradictory testimony and a casebook full of fragments.	Echoes uses fixed investigation locations and comic memories instead of free keyword search.
Gorogoa	Narrative told through illustrated panels	Treat comic composition and transitions as gameplay.	Echoes does not rely on panel rearrangement.
The Case of the Golden Idol	Observation and deduction interface	Every clue should earn its space and support a hypothesis.	Echoes's deductions focus on one supernatural disappearance and memory manipulation.
The Roottrees are Dead	Browser mystery with evidence relationships	Use a lightweight visual board that progressively reveals connections.	Echoes centres three witnesses and an unreliable investigator.
Pentiment	Narrative investigation with coherent art language	Make text, clues, art and UI feel like one artifact.	Echoes is much shorter and supernatural.

Sources: Papers, Please — <https://papersplea.se/presskit/> | Return of the Obra Dinn — <https://obradinn.com/> | Her Story — <https://www.herstorygame.com/about/> | Gorogoa — <https://www.xbox.com/en-IN/games/store/gorogoa/C41M2F4NWB2S> | The Case of the Golden Idol —

https://store.steampowered.com/app/1677770/The_Case_of_the_Golden_Idol/ | The Roottrees are Dead — <https://roottrees.com/en/> | Pentiment — <https://www.obsidian.net/games/pentiment>

3. Recommended implementation stack

- Recommended: Phaser 3 + TypeScript + Vite, deployed as a static browser build. This matches the desktop-browser, mouse-first, 2D, 16:9 requirement and avoids unnecessary 3D-engine overhead.
- Use one Phaser Scene per major state: Boot, Title, Opening, Village, Conversation, Memory, Deduction, InvestigationLocation, Aftermath, Casebook, Archive, Finale, Ending, Credits.
- Use JSON during development; if the team follows the blueprint's CSV requirement, keep CSV as the authoring format and convert/load it into typed objects at build time.
- Use browser localStorage for the single auto-save. Save after every new clue, confirmed deduction, unlocked location and finale milestone.
- Use one global GameState. UI scenes read/write through GameState and EvidenceResolver/DeductionController so the investigation remains deterministic.

Phaser references: <https://docs.phaser.io/phaser/concepts/scenes> | <https://docs.phaser.io/phaser/concepts/input> | <https://docs.phaser.io/phaser/concepts/tweens>

4. Core code architecture

Module	Responsibility	Must not do
GameState	Stores evidence, deductions, locations, witness states, casebook discoveries, finale state and settings.	No UI animation code.
StoryData	Loads witnesses, panels, evidence, deductions, relationships and ending text.	No runtime mutation.
EvidenceResolver	Checks whether required evidence is present and returns authored relationships.	Never invents clues or auto-solves unsupported hypotheses.
DeductionController	Handles hypothesis screens, validation and confirmation.	No rendering code and no hidden story truth.
MemoryController	Panel zoom, evidence hotspots, spirit-light inspection and page progress.	No final-story resolution.
CasebookController	Projects clue cards, timeline and evidence threads from GameState.	No independent story database.
SaveManager	Serializes GameState to localStorage.	No transient animation state.
AudioManager	Music/SFX buses, volume, mute and crossfade.	No story progression.
TransitionManager	Comic wipe, zoom, fade and Reduce Motion behavior.	No story truth.

5. Minimal runtime data model

```
GameState {
  evidence: { ids: string[] },
  deductions: { sis_1: "open|confirmed", sis_2: "open|confirmed", sis_3: "open|confirmed",
    bro_1: "open|confirmed", bro_2: "open|confirmed", bro_3: "open|confirmed", mom_1: "open|confirmed", mom_2: "open|confirmed", mom_3: "open|confirmed" },
  witnesses: { sister: "active|resolved", brother: "active|resolved", mother: "active|resolved" },
}
```

```

locations: { clockTower, riverRoute, archive },
casebook: { panels: string[], evidence: string[], notes: string[], threads: string[] },
finale: "locked|ready|revealed|complete",
settings: { music, sfx, textSize, textSpeed, reduceMotion, reduceFlashing }
}

```

6. Evidence/deduction flow - implement this before the rest of the story

1. At the end of a memory, collect evidence fragments inspected during that visit and update GameState.evidence.
2. When a new clue appears, look up its authored relationships. Create only the explicit Corroborates, Contradicts or Reveals thread records.
3. A deduction becomes available when every required evidence ID is known. The player may form a hypothesis and confirm it.
4. If the hypothesis is unsupported, return to the evidence screen without penalty. If supported, set the deduction to confirmed and unlock its authored consequence.
5. Later witness conversations can expose new questions when the corresponding clue or thread exists. Completed memories remain read-only.
6. Build and test the Mira + Arun contradiction loop first, then complete Leela and the archive.

7. Build order — start coding in this order

Order	Implementation target
1. Project skeleton	Browser build, 1920×1080 logical canvas, responsive letterboxing, Boot/Title/Village scenes.
2. GameState + SaveManager	Evidence states, deduction states, localStorage, Continue/New Game, settings.
3. Generic MemoryPage	One reusable witness-memory scene loaded from data.
4. Evidence interaction	Panel zoom → inspect SFX/object → reveal clue → add to GameState.
5. DeductionController	Evidence requirements → hypothesis screen → confirm/reject → casebook update.
6. Village + InvestigationLocations	Witness status, clock tower, river route, workshop/well, archive unlocks.
7. Casebook	Cards + timeline + relationship threads; viewer over GameState.
8. Opening + conversations	Add authored content after evidence loop is stable.
9. Witness resolutions	Build the three short resolution beats and return-to-village flow.
10. Finale + truth ending	Build after all nine deductions and archive state are reliable.
12. Playtest	Test contradiction comprehension first, then full build and replay hook.

8. Resources and license-safe sources

Resource	Use	License / condition	Source
Kenney	UI, cursors, particles, grunge/splat effects	CC0/public domain on Kenney asset pages; retain the pack license file.	https://kenney.nl/
ambientCG	Paper/cork/wood textures	CC0 1.0 for downloadable assets.	https://ambientcg.com/
OpenGameArt	Optional art/music/SFX	Check each asset; CC-BY requires attribution.	https://opengameart.org/

Freesound	Crickets, wind, room tone, whispers	Use individual CC0 files for simplest workflow; record creator + URL.	https://freesound.org/
ChipTone	Custom comic SFX/UI sounds	Sounds created with ChipTone are CC0.	https://sfbgames.itch.io/chiptone
Scott Buckley	Echoes Of Home / Penumbra	CC BY 4.0; attribution required.	https://www.scottbuckley.com.au/library/
Kevin MacLeod / Incompetech	Mystery/finale music	Use exact current attribution/license text from source page.	https://incompetech.com/music/royalty-free/
Krita	Original comic art + .kra sources	Free/open-source art tool.	https://krita.org/
Google Fonts	Comic/narration font	Choose a font explicitly licensed under SIL OFL 1.1.	https://fonts.google.com/

9. Important asset/license notes

- The Outlander Free CC0 Village Backgrounds Pack is explicitly labeled CC0 and AI-generated by its creator. If used, keep the AI disclosure required by the blueprint and record the source. Prefer original team art for final visual consistency.
- Do not treat 'free' as equivalent to CC0. Safest workflow: CC0 first, then CC BY with attribution. Avoid NC/ND, unclear licenses and packs with no stated license.
- Freesound licenses are selected per sound. Check the individual file before committing it.
- Keep CREDITS.md from day one: asset name, creator, source URL, license, modification note and where used.

10. Critical implementation holes to resolve before art production

- Lock the engine: this appendix assumes Phaser 3 + TypeScript. If the team already uses Unity, keep the same data/state architecture and implement equivalent WebGL scenes.
- Verify the official jam rules separately before Hour 12; the blueprint's submission checklist is the design team's working interpretation, not an independently verified event-rule source.
- Draw one master comic panel per evidence scene. Use code for spirit-light overlays, evidence highlights and contradiction stamps rather than duplicating art.
- Give every evidence fragment a stable ID. Do not key evidence only by screen coordinates.
- Give every evidence item and deduction a stable ID, source panel, required evidence IDs, conclusion text, witness reaction and explicit relationship IDs.
- Do not let a clue automatically solve deductions that were not explicitly authored.
- Enumerate all six witness visit orders before final dialogue and evidence gating are locked.
- Make the casebook a projection of GameState, not an independent story database.
- Use one 1920×1080 logical coordinate system and scale the whole game for different browser sizes.
- Compress WebP art and lazy-load later memory pages if the WebGL build becomes large.

11. Research source list

Papers, Please press kit — <https://papersplea.se/presskit/>

Return of the Obra Dinn — <https://obradinn.com/>

Her Story — <https://www.herstorygame.com/about/>

Gorogoa — <https://www.xbox.com/en-IN/games/store/gorogoa/C41M2F4NWB2S>

The Case of the Golden Idol —
https://store.steampowered.com/app/1677770/The_Case_of_the_Golden_Idol/

The Roottrees are Dead — <https://roottrees.com/en/>

Pentiment — <https://www.obsidian.net/games/pentiment>

Phaser Scenes — <https://docs.phaser.io/phaser/concepts/scenes>

Phaser Input — <https://docs.phaser.io/phaser/concepts/input>

Phaser Tweens — <https://docs.phaser.io/phaser/concepts/tweens>

Kenney — <https://kenney.nl/>

ambientCG — <https://ambientcg.com/>

OpenGameArt licensing FAQ — <https://opengameart.org/node/5571>

Freesound licensing FAQ — <https://freesound.org/help/faq/>

ChipTone — <https://sfbgames.itch.io/chiptone>

Scott Buckley — Echoes Of Home — <https://www.scottbuckley.com.au/library/echoes-of-home/>

Scott Buckley — Penumbra — <https://www.scottbuckley.com.au/library/penumbra/>

Kevin MacLeod — Lightless Dawn — <https://incompetech.com/music/royalty-free/index.html?isrc=USUAN1100655>

The Outlander — Free CC0 Village Backgrounds — <https://the-outlander.itch.io/free-cc0-village-backgrounds-pack-24-05-24-09-49-07>